



The sorceress knew that this task was impossible for Gunnar, but not for Sigurd. She used her magic powers to transform Sigurd into Gunnar. In this new form, he walked unharmed through the inferno, and then returned to his own shape. Fooled by the sorceress's magic, and with a heavy heart, Brynhildr agreed to marry Gunnar.

*The two couples – Sigurd and Gudrun, Gunnar and Brynhildr – were wed on the same day.*

Later, the two young wives went bathing in a river. “My husband’s more courageous than yours,” Brynhildr said. “Only he was brave enough to pass through my fire.”

Annoyed by her bragging, Gudrun said that she knew that Brynhildr had been cheated into marrying Gunnar.

Brynhildr was furious. She felt betrayed by Sigurd and in her anger she arranged to have him killed.

However, once the dreadful deed was done, Brynhildr was full of regret. She took her own life and was burned alongside Sigurd on his funeral pyre.

